

Ancient Indian History - Practice Set 01

RRB NTPC 2026 - History Syllabus Practice Series
Comprehensive Mixed Chapters Mock Test (10 Questions)

Question 1 — Topic: Prehistoric Period

Which prehistoric site in India is globally famous for its Paleolithic and Mesolithic rock shelters and magnificent cave paintings?

- A) Hunsgi
- B) Bhimbetka (Correct)
- C) Mehrgarh
- D) Chirand

Explanation: Bhimbetka in Madhya Pradesh is a UNESCO World Heritage site featuring rock shelters that show evidence of prehistoric human life and extensive cave paintings.

Question 2 — Topic: Indus Valley Civilization

Which Indus Valley Civilization site features a massive tidal dockyard, indicating prominent maritime trade with Mesopotamia?

- A) Harappa
- B) Mohenjo-daro
- C) Lothal (Correct)
- D) Kalibangan

Explanation: Lothal in Gujarat possessed a sophisticated basin structure identified as an artificial tidal dockyard.

Question 3 — Topic: Vedic Period

The famous 'Gayatri Mantra', dedicated to the solar deity Savitri, is contained in which of the following ancient texts?

- A) Rigveda (Correct)
- B) Samaveda
- C) Yajurveda
- D) Atharvaveda

Explanation: The Gayatri Mantra is composed in the third mandala of the Rigveda, attributed to Sage Vishvamitra.

Question 4 — Topic: Religious Movements

At which of the following historical locations did Gautama Buddha attain Mahaparinirvana (his passing away)?

- A) Sarnath
- B) Kushinagar (Correct)
- C) Bodh Gaya
- D) Lumbini

Explanation: Gautama Buddha attained Mahaparinirvana at Kushinagar (capital of the Mallas) in Uttar Pradesh around the age of 80.

Question 5 — Topic: Mahajanapadas

What was the earliest capital of the powerful Magadha Mahajanapada before it was shifted to Pataliputra?

- A) Rajagriha (Correct)
- B) Vaishali
- C) Kashi
- D) Ujjain

Explanation: Rajagriha (Girivraja), surrounded by five hills, was the strategic early capital of Magadha during the reigns of Bimbisara and early Ajatashatru.

Question 6 — Topic: Mauryan Empire

The Greek writer Megasthenes, author of the detailed account 'Indica', was an ambassador sent to the court of which Mauryan king?

- A) Ashoka
- B) Chandragupta Maurya (Correct)
- C) Bindusara
- D) Dasharatha

Explanation: Megasthenes was sent by Seleucus I Nicator as an ambassador to the court of Chandragupta Maurya at Pataliputra.

Question 7 — Topic: Post-Mauryan Period

Which prominent Kushan ruler is well-known for convening the Fourth Buddhist Council and being a major patron of Mahayana Buddhism?

- A) Kanishka (Correct)
- B) Kujula Kadphises
- C) Vima Kadphises
- D) Huvishka

Explanation: Kanishka the Great convened the Fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir and was a key patron of Mahayana Buddhism.

Question 8 — Topic: Gupta Empire

Which Gupta emperor was described as the 'Napoleon of India' by the historian Vincent Smith due to his extensive military campaigns?

- A) Chandragupta I
- B) Samudragupta (Correct)
- C) Chandragupta II
- D) Skandagupta

Explanation: Samudragupta's extensive military achievements across Aryavarta and Dakshinapatha earned him this title from historians.

Question 9 — Topic: South Indian Dynasties

The magnificent rock-cut Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram was constructed under the patronage of which South Indian dynasty?

- A) Chola Dynasty
- B) Pandya Dynasty
- C) Western Chalukyas
- D) Pallava Dynasty (Correct)

Explanation: The Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram was built during the reign of Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha) of the Pallava dynasty.

Question 10 — Topic: Post-Gupta Period

The Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang) visited India during the reign of which prominent North Indian monarch?

- A) Harshavardhana (Correct)
- B) Chandragupta II
- C) Pulakeshin II
- D) Skandagupta

Explanation: Hiuen Tsang visited India during the 7th century CE under the reign of King Harshavardhana of Kannauj.